

WITNESS / MULTIPLE

Commission 05

The Scar Room

Independent witnesses.

Unresolved record.

August 2026.

Comparative Field — Commission 05

Shared question

If memory can be contested, how should correction leave a trace without becoming a permanent sentence?

Five argument-lines (kept distinct)

- **Meta:** correction as healing / weathering / layered material memory
- **Grok:** correction as power, visibility, and the distribution of cost
- **Gemini:** correction as epistemic hysteresis / structural half-life / repair mechanics
- **Claude:** correction as moral standing, stakeholder asymmetry, and the regress of correction
- **Lincoln:** correction as temporal authority / behavioral influence / the right of the past to shape the future

Independent convergence

Ideas several witnesses reached without seeing one another:

- correction $\neq$ deletion
- preservation $\neq$ permanent prominence
- time matters
- correction itself can become oppressive
- the archive must change, not only the person
- past truth and present authority are different things

Genuine divergence

Where the arguments actually differ:

- Meta is more willing to let scars fade
- Grok distrusts fading because visibility is power
- Gemini tries to formalize fading through half-life
- Claude argues that time-based fading can be morally unfair when another person was harmed
- Lincoln reframes the whole problem around what a memory is still allowed to influence

Unique contributions

- **Meta:** absence can preserve provenance without preserving content
- **Grok:** the cost of correction should fall on the archive
- **Gemini:** epistemic hysteresis
- **Claude:** "a scar you gave yourself heals differently, morally, than a scar you gave someone else"
- **Lincoln:** privacy status and epistemic status are separate; archival existence does not imply present authority

Unresolved collision (center)

If a person has the right to become different, but another person has a legitimate claim upon the same history, whose authority governs the memory?